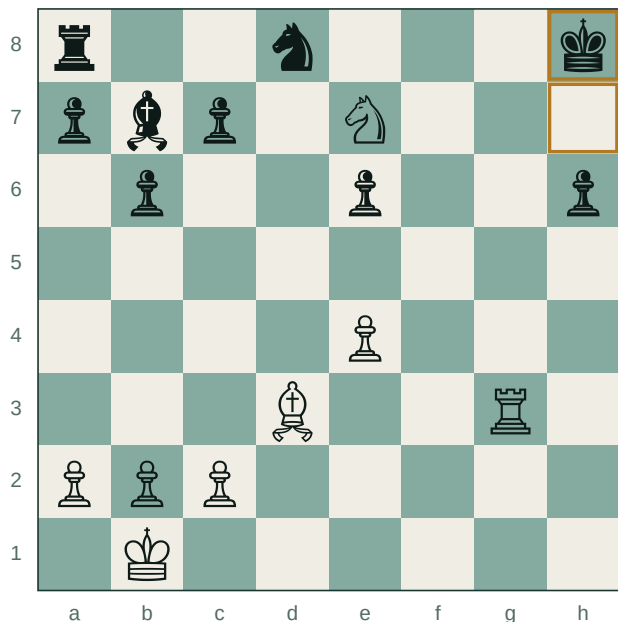


Discovered checks: White, move 28

Discovered checks

White to move



Previous move: 27...Kh8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28. Rg8+ Kh7 29. e5+ Be4 30. Bxe4#

28.Rg8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From g8 it attacks king on h8 and knight on d8. Recorded reply: **28...Kh7**.

29.e5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the bishop on d3 attacks the king on h7. Recorded reply: **29...Be4**.

30.Bxe4# Mate: bishop on e4 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Bishop on e4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.